



Above: 3D design art (Chris Ross)

Right: Keyframe art (Ryan Meinerding)

The Micro-Robotic Assembly System was an early idea from Jon Favreau. The elaborate machine would establish Stark — after returning wounded and weary from his torture in Afghanistan — as able to maintain the RT's function with the aid of self-controlled, highly sensitive, robotic equipment; in effect, he would be able to perform microsurgery upon himself. Meinerding devised the translucent computer screen above Stark to give him a visual aid of the tense game of "Operation" he was playing with the life-giving RT unit set in his chest cavity. Further, with his arms resting inside the Assembly System's controls, Stark would be able to translate the subtlest movements of his hands and fingers to a microsurgical scale by the giant, hydraulic arms of the robot.

In the end, this most sci-fi of sequences was abandoned and given over to the more human scene in which Stark's loyal aide Pepper Potts assisted in the replacement of the RT. Nonetheless, the Micro-Robotic Assembly System was a fruitful inspiration for other elements of the art of *Iron Man*.